

S P O R T I F

Brand & Market Insight

Prepared for Lucy Wayne, ahead of our first meeting

June 2026 · From Hugo, your brand and design partner

Groundwork for your brand

When you filled out the intake questionnaire, the goal was simple: give us the raw material to brand Sportif properly, your why, your customer, your voice and your references. That alone was plenty to start designing from.

With your answers as the anchor, we went one step further and ran a fast, deep look at the market and the brands you named. This was not on your brief, and it is not us second-guessing your idea. It is groundwork, so that the brand we build for you stands out in a category that has filled up quickly, and is built to last.

What follows is a short tour of what we found, the parts of your thinking the research backed up, an honest read of the market, and a design direction we are genuinely excited about. We would love to shape it with you tomorrow.

Everything here is in service of one thing: launching Sportif beautifully, and successfully, in September.

The research backed your instincts

The strongest parts of Sportif came straight from your questionnaire, and the market data supports them.

- **Your customer** is the early-morning Sydney pilates woman who treats her activewear as self-expression and is tired of black and fluoro. Spot on, and a real, reachable audience.
- **Your feel**, Anine Bing's calm polish plus Kikiva's founder warmth, and never the tacky, skin-heavy look, is exactly the right set of references.
- **Your position**, affordable luxury, community, "too fashionable not to wear", is a lane the market leaves open.

A QUICK SWOT, FROM YOUR ANSWERS

STRENGTHS

Founder-led, a real design eye, a clear warm aesthetic, and existing press.

WEAKNESSES

Brand-new with no audience yet, a small first run, and naming and trademark still to lock.

OPPORTUNITIES

Pilates is the number-one fitness trend, the design-led accessory lane is open, sustainability matters to your customer, and you have a clean slate.

THREATS

Paid ads are pricey and restricted for this category, simple products get copied, and bigger brands have scale.

A healthy category, with one clear opening

The good news first: the category is growing, pilates is the number-one fitness trend, and your customer is actively buying beautiful accessories.

Something encouraging we found: a few lovely brands already share your vision for colourful accessories, selling bands and straps in soft colours at around \$19 to \$39. That is a good sign the instinct is right and there is real appetite for it, and it points straight at where Sportif can stand out.

The opening: look closely at all of them and every single band and strap is a flat, solid colour. Nobody puts a pattern or a texture on a band. That space is empty, and it is the most exciting thing we found.



Every competitor band and strap we found: a flat, solid colour. None patterned.

Your colour. Your pattern.

So we made a few concepts. These are quick mockups, not final products, but they show the idea: Sportif's warm, custom palette plus a woven texture or a soft print that no one else is putting on a band.



Woven texture



Warm stripes



Soft leopard



Botanical

"These colours, this pattern, only here."

The cotton pouch becomes a hero too (people happily buy a beautiful pouch), and the band, strap and pouch can be sold together as a giftable set, so Sportif is never competing as just another plain band.

For our chat tomorrow

None of this is decided. These are simply the few things we would love to think through with you, together.

1 The pattern.

We love it. The only next step is checking with your supplier what is makeable and affordable on a first run. A woven texture is likely easier than a full print, and either one is the thing that makes Sportif hard to copy.

2 The hero product.

Which piece leads the launch: the band, the vegan ankle strap, the pouch, or a beautiful set. Because the plain band is the most common item out there, leading with something more distinctive may serve you better.

3 The runway.

Whether we go wholesale-first into studios, or build your audience first. Both are good, they just pull in slightly different directions, so it helps to pick the lead one.

What we will bring along: the full interactive competitor board (attached to this email), your brand kit, and a simple plan from now to September.

This is your idea. Our job is to make it unmistakably yours, and impossible to ignore. Excited for tomorrow.

Attached: the interactive competitor product board. Open **competitor-product-board.html** in any browser to explore every brand, product and price we looked at. Prices current as of 16 June 2026.